BLOG HUB

BLOGGING & PUBLISHING PLATFORM

Product Requirements Document

Scope, personas, user stories, and functional and non-functional specifications for Blog Hub.

Document BlogHub-PRD-001

Version v1.0

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1. SCOPE

A publishing platform with three role-scoped surfaces over one content model: public reading, an author workspace, and admin moderation. This document specifies the product behaviour required to satisfy the business requirements in BlogHub-BRD-001.

2. PERSONAS & USER NEEDS

Role	Needs
Reader	Find and read articles, browse by category, comment without ceremony.
Author	Draft, preview, submit for review, publish, and see how a post performed.
Admin	Manage users and roles, oversee all posts, work a moderation queue, review reports.

3. USER STORIES & ACCEPTANCE CRITERIA

Reader

As a reader, I want to read an article without signing up, so that nothing stands between me and the content.

- Given a published article URL, when opened signed out, then the full article renders with no prompt or overlay.
- Given the URL is shared, when someone else opens it, then they see the same complete article.

As a reader, I want to browse by category, so that I can find more of what I already like.

- Given a category page, when it loads, then published articles appear newest first with pagination.
- Given a category holds no published articles, then the page explains that rather than rendering empty.

Author

As an author, I want to draft and preview before publishing, so that I can see exactly what a reader will see.

- Given an open draft, when previewed, then the rendering matches the published article view exactly.
- Given the editor is closed and reopened, then unsaved work has been retained as a draft.

As an author, I want to submit a post for review, so that an editor can approve it before it goes live.

- Given a draft, when submitted, then its state becomes "in review" and it appears in the admin queue.
- Given a post is in review, when a direct publish is attempted, then the transition is refused with an explanation.

Admin

As an admin, I want a moderation queue, so that comments are handled in one place.

- Given a comment from a first-time commenter, when submitted, then it is held pending and not publicly visible.

- Given a comment is approved or rejected, then the action, actor and time are written to the audit log.

As an admin, I want to manage roles, so that permissions match responsibility.

- Given a user role is changed, then access changes on their next request without a redeployment.
- Given an author is removed, then their published articles remain live under a retained attribution record.

4. FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

- Public homepage with featured and trending articles; category listings; article pages addressed by stable slug.
- Sign-in and sign-up for authors and admins only; reading never prompts for an account.
- Editor supporting formatted text, images, category assignment and a preview identical to the published view.
- Post states: draft, in review, published, archived — with permitted transitions enforced server-side.
- Author dashboard listing post counts by state and per-post view counts.
- Comments on published articles, with first-time commenters held for approval.
- Admin surfaces for users, posts, the comment queue and reported content, each action written to an audit log.

5. NON-FUNCTIONAL REQUIREMENTS

- Article pages carry title, description and canonical URL metadata; published slugs never change silently.
- Authorisation is enforced at the API layer, so hiding a control in the interface is never the only protection.
- Images are served at responsive sizes; an article must remain readable on a mid-range phone over a weak connection.
- Deleting a user preserves authored content under a retained attribution record.

6. MVP CUT

Public reading, authoring with draft and publish, comments with approval, and admin user management. Review workflow, archiving and reports followed once the core loop worked end to end.

7. SUCCESS CONDITIONS

- An article is readable, shareable and indexable without any account existing.
- No post reaches the published state without passing a permitted transition.
- Every moderation action can be traced to an actor and a timestamp.

8. OUT OF SCOPE / FUTURE WORK

- Scheduled publishing and revision history with diffs.
- Author-level analytics beyond view and comment counts.
- Newsletter distribution, AI-assisted drafting and tag suggestions, multi-publication accounts.